

and comes with a unique feature which most other general purpose virtualization software don't possess – porting real systems to virtual machines. While that's not impossible and there are ways around if you're going to use some advanced Linux commands, it's obviously dangerous. Anyway, this file format would allow your virtual machine to run on the “parallels” virtualization software packages.

Now that you know the benefits of the various formats, select the one which suits your needs and press “next”.

Now you get the option to select whether the file should be “dynamically allocated” or “fixed sized”. We recommend “dynamically allocated” for it saves the space which you won't be using in the virtual machine.

You get to select the filename and the location as well as the size of the file. It's better not to alter the default file location as they are usually good places and are easy to find. However, if you don't have enough space on the partition that the file is about to be created, well, change it to something else. Also, set the desired space (in case of a “dynamically allocated” image, this is the maximum space that would get allocated) for the virtual hard disk file. Press the next button. On the next screen, press the “Create” button to create the file.

Now you're done and have to press the “Create” button again to create the virtual machine and add it to the list of virtual machines in VirtualBox.

That is all, you have the machine ready. Unlike VMware Workstation, VirtualBox doesn't ask you to set the installation image and some other info. To set them, select the virtual machine you just created from the list and click on the “Settings” button. This will open a new window. Click on the “Storage” option on the left and then click on the DVD/CD icon in the list (it should be labeled “Empty”). When you select it, you'd find the option to alter the settings to the right (inside the “Attributes” section). You'll be able to change the drive type to “IDE Secondary” or “IDE Primary” and so on. Besides that, you'll find a button with an image of a CD on it. Click it for the options. You can either select a physical drive or select an ISO image to be used as the DVD/CD inside the VM. Choose one according to your needs and finalize the settings. In case you don't specifically set the DVD/CD drive or the ISO file to be used as installation media, VirtualBox will ask you on a dialog box for that when you first start the machine. Remember that this will happen once. If you close the dialog box without choosing any option, VirtualBox probably takes it as a personal insult and never asks you again. So ensure you change the settings mentioned above.